PROactive PRONUNCIATION

T Deletion Minimal Pair Sentences

The /t/, in particular at the end of words, is often deleted altogether. Dropping a /t/ can affect the meaning of many words. Words like “can’t” and “don’t” require that pesky little /t/ to be clear and obvious to the listener. If you drop that /t/, the meaning is lost entirely! Here are a few minimal pairs to compare words that have the /t/ and words that do not. Note how the meaning changes. Comparing these words is a great way to see what would happen if you were to mistakenly drop that oh, so important final /t/!

/t/ minimal pairs:

ate	a	late	lay
bite	bye	fort	four
date	day	light	lie
boat	bow	treat	tree
boot	boo	can’t	can
toot	two	out	ow
tote	toe	eat	E
meet	me		

Sentences:

I a<u>t</u>e a da<u>t</u>e

I took a bi<u>te</u> ou<u>t</u> of the radish roo<u>t</u>

I los<u>t</u> my boo<u>t</u> on the boa<u>t</u>

I’ll mee<u>t</u> you there, bu<u>t</u> don’<u>t</u> be la<u>te</u>

You should have a ligh<u>t</u> trea<u>t</u> before we go ou<u>t</u>

I can’<u>t</u> ea<u>t</u> mea<u>t</u>